

STEM ROBO KID'S · HTML TEMPLATE v1.0.0

How to Sell This Website Online

A step-by-step playbook for turning your finished template into a product that earns: what to fix first, what accounts you need, how to package it, where to list it, what to charge, and what to realistically expect.

12 steps · about 14 days to first listing · Prepared 9 September 2026

Seller document. Delete the whole **marketing/** folder before you ZIP the product for buyers.

STEP 0

Decide what you are actually selling

Three different businesses hide behind the words "sell this website". Pick one before you do anything else.

Model	What you sell	Price	Repeatable?	Fit for this folder
A. Template product	The same ZIP file, sold to unlimited strangers on a marketplace	\$19-39 each	Yes - build once, sell forever	Built for it already
B. Client project	One customised copy, installed on one robotics club's domain	\$300-1,500 once	No - new work each time	Works, needs your time
C. Website flip	The live site as a business: domain, traffic and revenue together	24-40x monthly profit	One-time	Not yet - no traffic, no revenue, nothing to value

This guide covers Model A.

Your folder already contains **README.md**, **CHANGELOG.md**, **LICENSE.txt**, a **documentation/** site and a **marketing/** folder. That is not a website - that is a packaged template product waiting for a marketplace. Steps 1 to 12 take it there. Model B is covered on the last page.

Why Model C is off the table today

Buyers on Flippa and Empire Flippers value a site on its *profit*, not its design. A brand-new site with no domain age, no visitors and no revenue has no multiple to apply, so it sells for scrap or not at all. Model C only becomes real after Model A or B has been running for twelve months or more with verifiable income.

STEP 1

Fix three false claims before anyone reads them

Do this first. It is the only genuinely blocking item in the whole guide.

Your ready-to-paste listing description in **marketing/SELLING-GUIDE.md** contains three statements that the code contradicts. I checked each one against the actual files.

The claim	What the files actually show	Replace it with
"No image files required - every visual is CSS, emoji or inline SVG"	False. 15 SVG image files are wired into the pages: hero, about-story, product-1 to product-6, team-1 to team-4, logo, logo-light and og-share. Your own assets/img/IMAGE-LIST.md documents all 15 as placeholders that must be swapped.	"15 image slots, pre-wired with placeholders. Drop in your own photos at the sizes listed - object-fit crops them for you, no CSS editing."
"the whole template is under 250 KB"	False. The product folder measures roughly 376 KB.	"Under 400 KB total." Still an excellent number - just say it accurately.
"Icons: Unicode emoji - no icon licence required"	False, and it undersells you. The pages carry 62 hand-drawn inline SVG icons. Your README.md already states this correctly, so your two documents currently disagree with each other.	"Icons: original inline SVG, drawn for this template. No icon font, no third-party licence, and they recolour with the theme."

Why this is worth an hour of your time

Marketplace reviewers spot-check feature claims against the files, and "description does not match the item" is a standard rejection reason. Worse, if it slips through, the first buyer who opens assets/img/ finds 15 placeholder files you said did not exist - that is a refund request and a one-star review, and reviews are permanent. The corrected wording is also simply a better pitch: hand-drawn SVG icons beat emoji, and pre-wired image slots are a feature, not an omission.

Also check while you are in there

- Your **README.md** credits table and the **SELLING-GUIDE.md** description must tell the same story about icons. Make README the source of truth.
- The description says the contact form "validates in the browser" and needs a service to actually send mail. Keep that sentence - honest limitations reduce refunds.
- Confirm every feature bullet you keep is one a buyer can see working in the live demo.

STEP 2

Open the accounts and gather the tools

Everything below is free except your time. Do the tax form early - it is the one item with a real delay.

What	Why you need it	Cost	Set-up time
Envato author account	To sell on ThemeForest, the largest template marketplace	Free	15 min
US tax form (W-8BEN)	Envato withholds tax on US sales. The form is where you claim your country's treaty rate. Filed inside Envato Settings, Tax Information.	Free	20 min, before your first sale
Gumroad account	Your fast, no-review sales channel. Live the same day.	Free, fee per sale	10 min
Payout method	PayPal, Payoneer or a bank account, depending on platform and country	Free	1-3 days to verify
Netlify account	Hosts the free live demo buyers click before they buy	Free	5 min
Google Chrome	Its DevTools takes the full-page screenshots you need for previews	Free	Already installed
Figma, Photopea or Canva	To stitch screenshots into the preview images	Free tier is enough	10 min
A ZIP tool	Windows Explorer's built-in Send to, Compressed folder is fine	Free	-

On the tax form

This is the step that quietly costs sellers money. If you do not complete the US tax form, the maximum withholding rate is applied to your US sales. If your country has a tax treaty with the US, completing the form correctly reduces that rate. Fill it in on day one, not after your first sale - it is not applied retroactively. If you are unsure which treaty article covers royalties, a local accountant will answer it in one short call.

STEP 3

Clean the folder, then ZIP it correctly

The buyer must never see your development files. A wrong ZIP structure is one of the most common soft rejections.

Delete these before zipping

Delete	What it is	Why it must go
marketing/	Your selling guide and preview sheet	Written for you, not the buyer. It contains your pricing strategy.
.claude/	Editor and agent configuration	Development clutter that means nothing to a buyer
.git/	Full version history	Exposes every draft and commit message, and bloats the ZIP
10k-websites-skill.zip	A stray archive in the project root	Not part of the product
total.png	A working screenshot	Not part of the product
This PDF	Seller documentation	It lives in marketing/, so it goes when that folder goes

Work on a **copy**. Never delete **.git/** from your own working folder - that is your version history. Duplicate the project, strip the copy, ZIP the copy.

```
# From the folder ABOVE Eye-catch, in PowerShell:

Copy-Item -Recurse Eye-catch stem-robo-kids
cd stem-robo-kids
Remove-Item -Recurse -Force marketing, .claude, .git
Remove-Item -Force 10k-websites-skill.zip, total.png
cd ..
Compress-Archive -Path stem-robo-kids -DestinationPath stem-robo-kids.zip
```

The structure reviewers expect

One top-level folder inside the ZIP. Not loose files, and not a folder inside a folder inside a folder.

```
stem-robo-kids.zip
  stem-robo-kids/
    index.html about.html products.html pricing.html
    gallery.html blog.html blog-single.html contact.html 404.html
    favicon.svg
    assets/          css/ (3 files) js/ (1 file) img/ (15 files)
    documentation/  index.html
    README.md  CHANGELOG.md  LICENSE.txt
```

Open your own ZIP before you upload it

Extract it to a fresh folder, double-click index.html, and click through every page. A large share of rejected submissions are packaging mistakes the seller would have caught in ninety seconds by opening their own file.

STEP 4

Run the quality gate

Twenty minutes here saves a two-week rejection cycle. Tick every box.

Functional

- [] All 9 pages open and every navigation link resolves - nothing 404s
- [] All 5 themes (Robo Pop, Bubblegum, Jungle Circuit, Space Cadet, Sunset Lab) checked on at least 3 different pages
- [] Theme choice survives a page reload - it is stored in localStorage
- [] Product, gallery and blog filters all work
- [] Gallery lightbox opens and closes, including with the Escape key
- [] Pricing monthly / termly toggle switches every plan
- [] Contact form shows its validation messages on empty and malformed input
- [] FAQ accordions open and close
- [] documentation/index.html opens and every sidebar link jumps correctly

Technical

- [] DevTools Console shows zero errors on every one of the 9 pages
- [] Each page passes validator.w3.org with no errors
- [] Tested on a real phone, not just a resized desktop browser
- [] Tab key reaches every interactive element and the focus ring is visible
- [] Tested in Chrome and in at least one of Firefox or Safari

Content

- [] No real names, real phone numbers or real addresses left in the demo content
- [] No placeholder text that reads as unfinished - lorem ipsum, TODO, XXX
- [] The three corrections from Step 1 are applied to your listing copy
- [] CHANGELOG.md version and date match what you are about to upload

Where you already stand

Verified in your files: 9 pages, all internal links resolve, 5 complete themes, full HTML documentation, a custom mascot and hand-drawn SVG icons, and only SIL Open Font License fonts with no photographs - so no unlicensed asset risk. The two items genuinely still on you are the **W3C validation run** and the **real-device test**.

STEP 5

Put a live demo online

Required by ThemeForest. Everywhere else it roughly doubles conversion. It takes about five minutes.

1. Take the cleaned product folder from Step 3.
2. Open **app.netlify.com/drop** in your browser.
3. Drag the whole folder onto the drop zone. No account is needed for the first deploy.
4. Wait around 30 seconds. Netlify returns a random URL such as *jade-otter-8821.netlify.app*.
5. Claim the site with a free account, then go to **Site configuration**, **Change site name**, and rename it to something like **stem-robo-kids-demo**.
6. Open the demo on your phone and confirm the layout holds and the theme switcher is reachable.
7. Save the final URL - every listing you create will ask for it.

Leave the theme switcher visible on the demo

Five switchable themes is your single strongest differentiator, and a buyer who clicks through them personally has already started imagining their own brand in it. Do not hide the switcher to make the demo look cleaner - clicking it is the pitch.

Netlify, Vercel, Cloudflare Pages and GitHub Pages all host this for free, since it is a pure static site with no build step. Netlify Drop is simply the fastest because it needs no repository.

One thing to remove from the demo

On the public demo, delete **documentation/**, **README.md**, **CHANGELOG.md** and **LICENSE.txt**. Visitors do not need them, and leaving the documentation publicly readable lets people take your customisation guide without buying. Those files still go in the ZIP the buyer receives.

STEP 6

Create the three preview images

You cannot list without these, and most buyers decide from the first two.

Image	Size	What it shows	Priority
Thumbnail	590 x 300 px	Template name plus "9 pages / 5 themes". It is displayed tiny in search results, so test it at 25% zoom - if you cannot read it, redo it.	Critical
Main preview	1180 px wide, any height	All 9 pages stitched vertically, best-looking page at the top.	Critical
Theme showcase	1180 px wide	The same hero section rendered in all 5 themes, side by side or stacked.	Your strongest asset - place it second

How to capture a full-page screenshot

1. Open the page in Chrome.
2. Press **F12** to open DevTools.
3. Press **Ctrl + Shift + P**.
4. Type **screenshot** and choose **Capture full size screenshot**.
5. Repeat for all 9 pages, then once per theme for the hero section.

How to stitch them

Open **marketing/preview-sheet.html** in Chrome and screenshot the bordered blocks - it is laid out for exactly this. Otherwise paste your captures into Figma, Photopea or Canva, stack them vertically on a 1180 px wide canvas, and export as JPG at around 80% quality.

Image order is a conversion decision, not a filing decision

Buyers scroll two or three images before they decide. Put your best-looking single page first, the five-theme showcase second, and everything else after. A great template with a dull first image loses to an average template with a striking one.

STEP 7

Choose where to sell

The trade-off is always the same: the platforms that bring you buyers take the largest cut.

Platform	You keep	Review	Brings its own buyers?	Best for
ThemeForest	55-70%, rising with exclusivity and lifetime sales	Strict. 5-15 days. Rejection is common and normal.	Yes - more than any other option	Real, ongoing passive income
Gumroad	About 90%	None. Live in minutes.	No - every visitor must come from you	Starting today and learning fast
Creative Market	60%	Light application review	Moderate	A design-led audience
TemplateMonster	50-70%	Moderate	Moderate	A useful third channel

Recommended: run both tracks at once

List on **Gumroad today** - there is no review, so you start collecting real feedback and possibly real money within an hour. **Submit to ThemeForest in parallel** and accept that it may take a fortnight and may come back rejected. Gumroad teaches you what to fix; ThemeForest is where the sustained income actually lives, because it is the only one of the four that reliably sends you buyers who were not already looking for you.

Exclusive or non-exclusive on Envato

- **Non-exclusive** pays a flat 45% but leaves you free to sell the same file on Gumroad and anywhere else.
- **Exclusive** starts at 55% and climbs toward 70% as your lifetime sales grow, but the item may then only be sold through Envato.
- For a first template, non-exclusive is the safer choice: it keeps the dual-track strategy above legal, and you can switch to exclusive later once you know the item actually sells.

Price it

Platform	Sensible range	Reasoning
ThemeForest	\$19 - \$29 regular licence	The standard band for a 9-page HTML site template. The 5 themes and the dark mode justify the top of the range.
Gumroad	\$24 - \$39	You keep about 90%, and there is no marketplace price anchoring you downward.
Creative Market	\$24 - \$39	Design-led buyers, less price-sensitive than marketplace shoppers.

Do not price below \$16

Very cheap templates read as low quality to the exact buyers you want, and your price caps your income for the entire life of the item. Raising a price later is much harder than launching at the right one. If sales are slow, the problem is almost always your preview images, not your price.

What justifies your upper-range price

- 9 pages, including a 404 and a full blog post layout that many competitors skip
- 5 complete colour themes with a live switcher and a genuine dark theme
- Zero dependencies - no jQuery, no Bootstrap, no build step, no npm install
- Under 400 KB in total, which is unusually light
- Full HTML documentation, not a one-page readme
- Accessibility work already done: keyboard navigation, ARIA states, reduced-motion support
- 62 original inline SVG icons and a custom mascot - no licensing questions

List it - the actual upload

9A. Gumroad, the fast path - about one hour

1. Create the product, set it as a digital download, and upload **stem-robo-kids.zip**.
2. Title it: *STEM Robo Kid's - Kids STEM, Robotics and Coding Club HTML Template*.
3. Paste the corrected description from Step 1 into the product page.
4. Upload the thumbnail and both preview images from Step 6.
5. Add your Netlify demo URL as a prominent link near the top.
6. Set the price and publish. It is live immediately.

9B. ThemeForest, the slow path - 5 to 15 days review

1. Sign in to Envato and choose **Author Dashboard, Upload an item**.
2. Category: *Site Templates, Retail / Corporate*, or the nearest Education match.
3. Upload the main ZIP, the 590 x 300 thumbnail, and the 1180 px preview images.
4. Enter your Netlify demo URL as the item preview - this is mandatory.
5. Paste the corrected description and the tag list: *kids, children, education, school, stem, robotics, coding, courses, learning, club, workshop, academy, colourful, playful, dark mode, responsive, html template*.
6. Set the regular licence price from Step 8.
7. Submit, then wait. Do not resubmit while it is queued - it only slows you down.

Do not paste the same tags everywhere without thinking

Tags are how buyers who have never heard of you find the item. "kids", "stem" and "robotics" are your genuine niche and have little competition. Generic tags like "responsive" and "html template" put you against tens of thousands of items and will never rank. Weight your list toward the niche.

STEP 10

If ThemeForest rejects it

Rejection is the normal first outcome, not a verdict on your work. Read which kind it is.

Type	What it means	What to do
Soft reject	Fixable problems, listed specifically. The item stays in your queue.	Fix exactly what they listed, change nothing else, and resubmit through the same item. This is the good outcome - they have told you the answer.
Hard reject	"Does not meet our current quality standard", usually with no detail. You cannot resubmit the same item.	Do not argue and do not resubmit the same file. Sell it on Gumroad and Creative Market immediately, gather buyer feedback, and rework it into a meaningfully different v2 later.

Common rejection reasons, and where your files actually stand

Reason	Your status
Too few pages	Clear - 9 pages
No documentation	Clear - a full HTML documentation site is included
Console errors	Clear on inspection, but re-verify after any edit
Broken links	Clear - all internal links resolve
Unlicensed assets	Clear - SIL Open Font License fonts only, no photographs, original SVG
Generic or templated design	Clear - custom mascot and a distinctive visual style
Invalid HTML	STILL ON YOU - run validator.w3.org on all 9 pages
Poor mobile layout	STILL ON YOU - test on a real device
Description does not match the item	STILL ON YOU - apply the three Step 1 corrections

The three open items are all in Step 1 and Step 4

Everything a reviewer would reject you for structurally is already handled. What remains is validation, a real-device test, and honest listing copy - perhaps two hours of work in total.

STEP 11

After it goes live

Ranking on these platforms is behavioural. What you do in the first sixty days compounds.

Do this	Why it matters
Reply to every comment within 24 hours	Response time is weighted in marketplace search ranking, and buyers name it explicitly in reviews. It is the cheapest ranking lever you have.
Ask for a rating in the documentation footer	Already written into your documentation. Ratings drive both ranking and conversion.
Ship an update within 60 days	"Last updated" is visible to buyers, and a stale date suppresses sales. Even a small update resets it. Log it in CHANGELOG.md and bump the version.
Answer support questions publicly where you can	Every public answer is content that helps the next undecided buyer.
Track which preview image people click	If traffic is high and sales are low, the problem is the demo or the price. If traffic is low, the problem is the thumbnail and the tags.

Cheap v1.1 additions that each earn a new listing bullet

- A Coming Soon page - roughly an hour of work
- A sixth colour theme - one CSS block, since every colour already lives in one file
- A second home-page hero variant
- An RTL (right-to-left) stylesheet, which opens up an entirely new buyer market
- A pre-wired Formspree or Web3Forms integration for the contact form

STEP 12

What to realistically expect

The part most selling guides leave out.

Channel	Honest expectation
Gumroad with no audience	Close to zero sales on its own. Gumroad has no discovery - it is a checkout page, not a marketplace. Sales come only from traffic you send: Reddit, Facebook groups for robotics educators, LinkedIn, X, or direct outreach to clubs.
ThemeForest, first year	Most first items sell in the low tens of copies, not hundreds. At \$24 and a 55-70% share, that is meaningful pocket money rather than a salary.
Your specific niche	Kids STEM and robotics is genuinely under-served on template marketplaces, which cuts both ways: very little competition, but also modest search volume. A narrow niche with low competition usually beats a crowded one for a first item.
What actually moves the needle	The second and third templates. Authors with a portfolio sell disproportionately more than the sum of their items, because buyers browse an author's other work and the platform rewards catalogue depth.

The strongest move after listing is not marketing

It is building template number two. One item is a lottery ticket; a portfolio of five in the same niche is a business. You now have the pipeline - the second one takes a fraction of the time the first did.

The 14-day plan

Days	Do this
1	Apply the three Step 1 corrections. Open the Envato and Gumroad accounts. File the tax form.
2	Clean the folder, build the ZIP, then extract it and test the extraction.
3	Run the full quality gate: W3C validation on all 9 pages, real-device test, console check.
4	Deploy the Netlify demo and test it on a phone.
5-6	Capture and stitch the thumbnail, the main preview and the theme showcase.
7	List on Gumroad. It is live the same day.
8	Submit to ThemeForest.
9-14	Post the demo in robotics-educator and web-design communities. Start template number two while you wait for the review.

If you would rather sell it once, to one club

Model B from Step 0. Slower per unit, but the money per sale is far larger and it needs no marketplace approval.

A local robotics club, coding school or STEM academy will pay several hundred dollars for a finished website - far more than a template licence - because they are buying an outcome, not a ZIP file. The template you have just built is your portfolio piece and your delivery vehicle at the same time.

1. Keep the Netlify demo live. It is your entire sales pitch.
2. List 20 local STEM clubs, robotics academies and coding schools. Prioritise the ones whose current website is dated or missing.
3. Send a short personal email with one line about what you noticed, the demo link, and one question. Do not attach anything and do not write more than five sentences.
4. Offer a fixed price for a fixed scope: their logo, their colours, their real text, their photos in the 15 image slots, contact form connected, deployed to their domain.
5. Charge for hosting, content updates or an annual care plan separately - that is the recurring revenue.
6. Deliver, then ask for a testimonial and a referral. Referrals are how this model scales.

The two models feed each other

Every client project produces new sections, new pages and new colour themes that you can fold back into the template product - and every template sale is a small advert that occasionally produces a client enquiry. Run Model A for the passive income and Model B for the cash flow.

Final pre-flight, one line each

- [] Three false claims corrected in the listing copy
- [] marketing/, .claude/, .git/, the stray .zip and total.png all deleted from the copy
- [] ZIP contains exactly one top-level folder and opens cleanly when extracted
- [] All 9 pages pass W3C validation with zero console errors
- [] Tested on a real phone
- [] Netlify demo live, theme switcher visible, docs removed from the demo
- [] Thumbnail readable at 25% zoom
- [] Theme showcase is the second image
- [] Price at or above \$19
- [] Tax form filed